a region', the TTP effectively challenged the writ of the provincial government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (formerly NWFP) and the federal government of Pakistan in FATA and in Malakand agency, especially Swat Valley through subversion and militancy. In FATA, the TTP undermined the administration and tried to run a parallel government. The Political Agent, a powerful institution representing the federal government, was confined to his office only.[3] The ancient system of handling the tribes through *Maliks* was shattered as more than 200 Maliks were killed in FATA within three years. TTP extremists frequently resorted to beheadings, killing for petty reasons, inhuman treatment of opponents, occupying girls' schools and destruction of government and private property with a view to establishing their writ in the area and creating fear (*The News International*, 2009).

In 2011, a majority of people in KP celebrated Eid on 7 November as announced by the government, but in parts of TTP-dominated Bara tehsil of Khyber Agency and Orakzai Agency and some tribal areas, it was celebrated on 6 November. Lashkar-e-Islami announced via FM radio the residents of Seepah, Malikdin Khel, Akkakhel, Shalobar and Qamarkhel Bara to celebrate Eid on 6 November. The Shura (Central Committee) of Amr Bil Maruf was Nahi Anil Munkar (Haji Namdar Group), which also made the similar announcement (*Dawn*, 2011).

The militants were even active in flood relief when worst floods hit KP and other areas of Pakistan. They continued their struggle against the state despite the flood disaster. An attack launched by insurgents from the Khyber tribal region on a police post killed two civilians in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa who had been active with a militia set-up against the militants. Attacks in other places continued in an organised and indefatigable manner as in the past. The militants remained highly organised and capable of striking at any time. While Interior Minister Rehman Malik announced that the militants would not be allowed to take advantage of the flood situation by carrying out relief activities, in reality, they were already creating a space for themselves among people and taking advantage of government failings to strengthen their own position. The set-up of training as fighters made them capable of doing so. The continued attacks were only to demoralise security forces and the population as a whole. Their successes were limited by the credibility of the government and the Interior Minister (*The News International*, 2010).